



Grief Support for Children, Teens, Families & Adults

We are all wounded
inside in some way or
other.

We all carry
unhappiness within
us for some reason
or another,

Which is why we
need a little
gentleness and
healing from one
another.

Healing in words,
healing beyond
words.

- Ben Okri

Comforting a Grieving Individual

Many people feel inadequate about what to say to a friend or family member who is grieving. This guide to comforting a grieving individual covers both words that offer comfort and words, that while well intended, may harm or stifle the bereaved, making the journey through grief more difficult.

Words that Comfort

I'm sorry.

I'm thinking of you.

I care and want to help.

I'm here for you.

*If I were in your shoes, I think I'd
feel that way too*

*One of my favorite memories of
_____ (use the name of the
person) is...*

*It seems so natural to cry at a time
like this.*

*I don't know what to say but I
know this must be very difficult for
you.*

Do you feel like talking for a while?

How do you feel today?

Words that May Not Comfort

Now she's in a better place.

Time will heal you.

*Think of all you have to be thankful
for.*

*Just be happy that he's out of his
pain.*

Be strong. You are holding up well.

Keep busy.

Try not to think about it.

*He wouldn't have wanted you to
be sad.*

This is a blessing

Now you have an angel in heaven.

You shouldn't feel that way.

Stop acting like a baby.

You need to be strong.

Saying nothing or pretending the death didn't happen also hurts the individual in the long run. It is important for this person to hear words of comfort from you and especially from friends, family members, or colleagues to whom he/she is close.